

AC Presents 2 New Pieces

Technical rider & CultureHub LA & September 16 to 25, 2026

SEPT 24 CONFIRMED · SEPT 19 PENDING

Two events, three different machine systems. The patch changes between them.

Date	Event	Shape
Sat Sep 19, 2:00–3:30 p.m.	Grokaesthetic Workshop	Participatory; bring your own computer
Thu Sep 24, 7:00 p.m.	<i>Note(s)pat(ial) Native</i> & <i>The Mac-NeoPolitan Trio</i>	Performance, conversation, free play

Thursday September 24 is confirmed. Saturday September 19 is still open: the guest set has been cut, and with it some of the case for two nights. Whether the workshop stays on Saturday or folds into Thursday is the one question outstanding. This rider covers both; if they merge, the workshop’s requirements move to Thursday afternoon and nothing else changes.

The performance is two works. They share the room and the Kalio system but run **different machines on different software**, and the patch changes between them — please read both system sections.

The three systems at a glance

System	Machines	What the house provides
Workshop	Participant laptops and phones, plus loaners	Guest Wi-Fi for 25–35 devices with downloads permitted; participant power; stereo minimum
<i>Note(s)pat(ial) Native</i>	Six surplus laptops booted from AC OS USB drives	Six discrete inputs to the Kalio system; projection
<i>The MacNeoPolitan Trio</i>	Three MacBook Neos running Menu Band on macOS	Three discrete full-range positions; outbound NTP

Event one

Grokaesthetic Workshop & Saturday

Two of the three ways in depend on the house network. Confirm it early.

Ninety minutes, hands-on, free and open to the public. Participants arrive with their own laptops and phones, get Aesthetic.Computer running on them, and the room finishes by playing together as one ensemble in the surround system.

Three ways in

1. **Browser** — anyone plays notepad at aesthetic.computer on the device they walked in with. Needs guest Wi-Fi that reaches the open internet.
2. **Menu Band on a Mac** — a free, signed macOS app, roughly a minute to install. Needs guest Wi-Fi that permits **app downloads**, not a portal that allows browsing only.
3. **AC OS from a USB stick** — boots a laptop into the operating system without touching its disk. Needs **permission to boot participant machines from USB in the space**; nothing is installed or altered.

What the workshop needs

- **Guest Wi-Fi sized for roughly 25–35 simultaneous devices**, with app downloads permitted. This is the single highest-risk item: a captive portal or a download block turns the middle path off at the door.
- **Power for participants** — strips reaching the seating, enough for about 20 laptops. Assume nobody arrives charged.
- Tables or floor seating for participants and their machines, arranged so people can see each other rather than a stage.
- **Loaner fleet positions** — the artist brings spare machines for anyone without a computer; they need power and a place to sit.
- **Stereo playback at minimum**, ideally the surround system, so the room can hear the group ensemble. Full six-channel routing is welcome but not required here.
- A snack table with a nearby bin. This is a real requirement: the workshop is part hangout by design.
- A microphone, or a room quiet enough to teach in — the artist is talking the whole time.

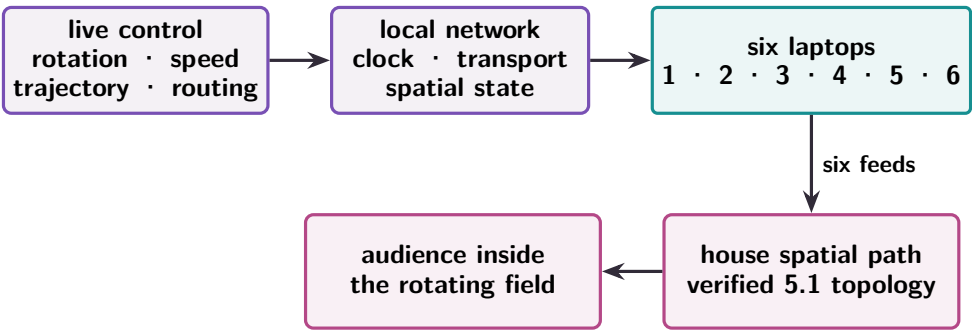
Access

No programming or musical experience is assumed, and loaner machines mean no one is turned away for lack of hardware. Please advise on accessible seating and whether the space suits participants who cannot sit on the floor.

Event two, work one

Note(s)pat(ial) Native

The laptop-to-speaker relationship moves during the performance.



System

- Six artist-supplied surplus grade-school laptops booted from six AC OS USB drives.
- Independent sound bodies distributed among the six laptops.
- Artist control surface for live rotation, trajectory, speed, and voice routing.
- Local wired or isolated Wi-Fi network for clock, transport, and spatial control.
- Six discrete audio feeds routed to CultureHub LA's 5.1 Kalio system.
- House projection showing the live spatial score.

Signal plan

Source	House destination
Laptops 1–5	Discrete full-range house inputs 1–5
Laptop 6	Full-range input 6 if available; otherwise a verified alternate route
Control laptop	Network control and projected score; no fixed audience-audio output
Documentation	Separate stereo fold-down, not the spatial performance bus

The relationship should not be hard-coded as six stationary voices: the system performs spatial rotation by moving sound bodies across the available full-range outputs. If CultureHub's sixth channel is LFE-only, the field will use the five full-range channels and send only derived low-frequency material to the LFE, or use an additional full-range speaker if the venue supplies and approves one.

Event two, work two

The MacNeoPolitan Trio

These machines do not boot AC OS and must not be asked to.

System

- Three MacBook Neos — indigo, citrus, blush — running **Menu Band** on macOS.
- Three discrete audio feeds, one per machine, placed to form a spatial triangle around the audience.
- The piece runs from a `.mbscore`: a JSON score declaring three machines and one voice each. All three fire at a shared start epoch and lock to the same downbeat.

What is different from work one, and why it matters

AC OS is x86_64 UEFI only; the MacBook Neo is Apple silicon. *The MacNeoPolitan Trio* runs Menu Band, a normal signed macOS app, on the machines' own installed systems. Nothing is booted from USB for this work.

Sync is by clock, not by cable. The three machines lock to one downbeat through NTP-synced wall clocks — typically tens of milliseconds across the fleet. There is no audio-clock link and no timecode between them, which means:

- They need **working network time**. If the house network blocks NTP, or the machines have been offline long enough to drift, the downbeat will smear. Please confirm outbound NTP is reachable, or allow a few minutes on a network that permits it before the performance.
- Conducting the three from one host uses ssh across the local network. If the house network isolates clients from each other, the fallback is to arm each machine locally — workable, but it needs a decision before the technical rehearsal, not during it.

Signal plan

Source	House destination
MacBook Neo — indigo	Discrete house input 1
MacBook Neo — citrus	Discrete house input 2
MacBook Neo — blush	Discrete house input 3

Three full-range positions, spread as widely as the room allows. Menu Band's audio comes out of each machine's own output; the only question is how CultureHub prefers to take three line-level feeds.

Changeover and the coda

The move from work one to work two is a **hardware swap, not a patch change** — six machines out, three in. The guest set that used to cover it has been cut, so the swap now happens in front of the audience: it needs five to ten budgeted minutes and a decision about what the room does meanwhile — house lights and talking, a held drone from the outgoing machines, or the score on the projector. After the music there is a conversation, and then the instruments stay on for the audience to play, so the rig should not be struck until the room clears.

House request

Audio & network & power & room

Audio and network

- Kalio 5.1 system with six independently addressable inputs.
- Audio interface or interfaces providing **six** line-level outputs for *Note(s)pat(ial) Native* and **three** for *The MacNeoPolitan Trio*; six total is sufficient if the patch can be changed between works.
- DI boxes, cabling, and adapters appropriate to the confirmed interfaces.
- Dedicated router or switch isolated from public traffic.
- **Outbound NTP reachable**, and confirmation of whether local clients can reach each other over ssh on the same subnet.
- **Guest Wi-Fi with internet access and app downloads permitted**, sized for 25–35 devices on the Saturday.

Power, room, projection

- **Nine** laptop power positions for the performance, conditioned power for audio and network gear, and **participant power strips for about 20 machines** on the Saturday.
- Six low tables or plinths for the surplus laptops, arranged around the audience field, plus **three stable surfaces** for the MacBook Neos.
- Projector, screen or projection wall, and an HDMI input near the performance position.
- Central seating for approximately 20–40 people, subject to room capacity.
- Snack table and bin for the workshop.
- Stereo livestream and documentation feed derived separately from the spatial mix.
- One technical rehearsal with CultureHub’s audio and streaming staff, long enough to change the patch between the two works and run both.

Responsibilities

What Jeffrey brings & what the venue confirms

Jeffrey brings

- Six tested surplus laptops and two spares.
- Six AC OS USB drives and two spares, plus workshop loaner sticks.
- Three MacBook Neos, each with Menu Band installed and the score pre-loaded.
- Loaner laptops for workshop participants without a machine.
- Laptop power supplies for all nine performance machines, and the primary control laptop.
- Owned USB, HDMI, and network adapters; software images and offline recovery media.

Confirm with CultureHub

- Exact Kalio speaker layout, sixth-channel bandwidth, and whether the system accepts six discrete inputs or requires a house spatialization interface.
- Available interface channel count, connectors, and sample rate.
- Wired network availability and house network policy — **outbound NTP, and client-to-client ssh.**
- **Whether guest Wi-Fi permits app downloads, and how many devices it holds.**
- **Whether participant laptops may be booted from USB in the space.**
- Projector resolution, throw, connectors, and screen location.
- Room dimensions, capacity, furniture, and accessible seating route.
- Livestream platform, capture format, archive ownership, and file delivery.
- Load-in, soundcheck, public-program, and strike hours, and **how much changeover time is available between the two works.**
- **Whether September 19 stays a separate event or folds into September 24.**

Risks

What the artist is carrying into the room

- **The citrus machine is the working development Mac and has 8 GB of RAM**, documented as exhausting memory under load. A hang during *The MacNeoPolitan Trio* stops one of three voices. Mitigation before load-in: perform from a clean boot with nothing else running, or swap in a fourth machine and keep citrus as the spare.
- **No spare third Neo yet.** The blush machine is unpurchased at the time of writing; until it exists there is no redundancy for the Trio.
- **Clock drift is the silent failure.** Unlike a dropped cable, a smeared downbeat still plays and just sounds wrong. It gets verified at the technical rehearsal, on the room's actual network.
- **The workshop depends on someone else's network.** Two of the three ways in need working guest Wi-Fi and the third needs USB-boot permission. If all three are blocked the session degrades to the artist's loaner fleet. This is not fixable on the day.



Aesthetic Computer & Pals · rider revised 18 August 2026